

Speaking Activity Outline:

Set-up

Instructor: Rhea Madhogarhia

Class: University English

Class Size: 20-30 students

Location:

Student English Level: Superior

Activity

Goal/Objective: Allow students to create and defend complex arguments and encourage complex back and forth discourse in English

Assessment: Direct, informal assessment of their performance in the debate and class voting for winner of each pair debate.

Materials Needed: Prep/priming sheet with the debate topic and case background, device for timing, paper for during debate notetaking and preparation

Student - Collaboration Format: three person team debates, group brainstorm per side of the debate, whole class reflection

Instructions:

Set-up (10 minutes)

- Introduce the debate topic
 - Class discussion on background knowledge of the topic (gauge what they already know/identify important vocab for the topic).
- Assign students into two teams: Pro and Against

Activity Execution (30 minutes)

Step 1: Preparation (10 minutes)

Each team of two brainstorms and prepares key points, evidence, and counterarguments.

Encourage use of advanced expressions and persuasive techniques.

Step 2: Debate (17 minutes)

Opening statements: Each team presents their argument (3 minutes per side, 1 minute per person).

Rebuttals: Teams respond to the opposing side (3 minutes per side).

Cross-examination: Open discussion where students ask opposing teams questions. (1.5 min per side)

Closing statements: Teams summarize and reinforce their stance. (1 min per side)

Step 3: Reflection (5 minutes)

Open class discussion:

- "What was the most convincing argument you heard today?"

- Instructor can be involved in this discussion with feedback on fluency, coherence, and persuasiveness.

Instructor wrap up (3-5 minutes)

- Provide constructive feedback and highlight effective speaking strategies.
- Assign a short reflective writing piece on the debate experience.